

MOOD OF THE NATION

DEFENCE/ FOREIGN AFFAIRS

BIG STICK DIPLOMACY

China and Pakistan remain New Delhi's big external challenges, but MOTN respondents endorse the government's stance on both, and a harder one on Kashmir

By **SANDEEP UNNITHAN**

India entered the new year looking at what could be a third year of a military stand-off with China in eastern Ladakh. A 14th round of Corps Commander-level talks on January 12 failed to resolve the military impasse that began in May 2020 when China moved two divisions across Ladakh. Both armies continue to eyeball each other at three contentious spots. And as long as these friction points remain, both sides will continue to deploy close to 100,000 troops at their respective ends at extremely high altitudes, making it the world's longest such military deployment.